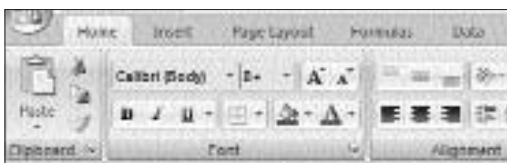


is tab-based, and the corresponding options and icons are displayed whenever a tab is selected. By default, the Ribbon has seven tabs—Home, Insert, Page Layout, Formulas, Data, Review, and View, and between them they cover most of the common user options. Other tabs, called Contextual Tabs, appear as and when needed depending on the object being worked with. In the case of Excel, the Developer Tab appears only when enabled in the application's preferences window.

The icons under each tab are grouped logically into blocks on the Ribbon, and only the most frequently-used command icons are displayed. In case more options need to be displayed, a small link at the bottom of the block can be clicked to pop out a separate window containing all the options.

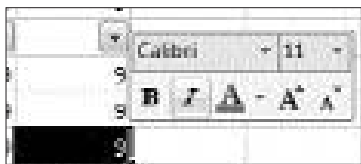
Besides the preset tabs, context-sensitive tabs appear on the Ribbon depending on the object selected. For example, tabs relat-



The Ribbon

ing to charts—like Design, Layout, and Format—only appear after a chart is created or selected.

The Mini Toolbar pops up on selecting a particular cell's contents. When dealing with a block of cells, it pops up next to the context menu, on right-clicking. The Mini Toolbar contains the frequently-used formatting options, and significantly decreases the mouse navigation involved. Options in the Mini Toolbar include font changes, numbering and bulleting, and more.



A look at the Mini toolbar